Answers and talk notes

Convert Measurement Units

What your student is learning

Tonight we convert customary units — feet to yards, ounces to pounds — and the whole skill is picking multiply or divide correctly.

Answers

Ask your student to explain before you look.

1. **B.** Divide, because yards are bigger. Divide, because yards are bigger, so there are fewer yards than feet.
2. **C.** 6. 18 ÷ 3 = 6, so 18 feet = 6 yards.
3. **D.** 24. 8 × 3 = 24, so 8 yards = 24 feet.
4. **A.** 4. 64 ÷ 16 = 4, so 64 ounces = 4 pounds.
5. **C.** 48. 3 × 16 = 48, so 3 pounds = 48 ounces.
6. **B.** 2. 10,560 ÷ 5,280 = 2, so 10,560 feet = 2 miles.

Talk about it

Are you changing to a smaller or a bigger unit, and will your answer be more or less than the starting number?

Home mission

Find a bag of flour, rice, or sugar with ounces on the label. Ask your student: how many ounces are in 3 pounds? If a bag says 64 ounces, how many pounds is that? Say "bigger or smaller?" before you calculate.

When they are stuck, ask

- Which unit is bigger — the one you have or the one you want?
- Will the number get bigger or smaller? Decide before you calculate.
- Can you multiply back to check?

Try not to say

- Conversions always multiply.
- Divide when the number looks too big, multiply when it looks too small.
- You do not need the conversion fact, just estimate.